



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Destiny Christian School & Preschool
School Website: <http://destinyschool.com>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Destiny Christian School Preschool Ny 14620 presents as a robust CLASSICAL Christian school in Rochester, NY. Public-facing materials emphasize a Classical Christian framework built on the Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric Trivium, a strong liturgical and communal life, and a formation-focused purpose that centers virtue, wisdom, and faith. Evidence across pages and articles shows explicit references to Classical Christian education, the Grammar stage, the Trivium, and a learning culture where faith and learning are braided (e.g., singing worship at the start of the day, Bible verses memorized through song, and a biblical worldview integrated into all subjects). The school highlights a multi-decade history, a community drawn from many area churches, and a faculty culture aligned with virtue and service. Taken together, these signals place Destiny Christian School Preschool Ny 14620 firmly in the classical education camp with a strong Christian substrate.

Key signals include: explicit identification as a Classical Christian school and emphasis on the Grammar stage and Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) in multiple pages; liturgical and communal practices such as daily singing worship and Scripture memory; and a mission framed in formation of character, virtue, and wisdom rather than mere information transfer. Public materials also stress partnership with families and open engagement with parents and community, aligning with classical education norms around parent formation and shared mission. The Positive keyword indicators from the classical school lexicon corroborate these signals, while the absence of anti-classical (negative) signals in the public materials supports a CLASSICAL classification.

Executive summary — Element-by-Element snapshot follows, with evidence drawn from Destiny's public-facing content and aligned to the Six Essential Elements framework.

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence for these conclusions is drawn from Destiny's site and related materials (quotes and page content cited below) as well as the classical lexicon and rubric indicators in the knowledge base.

- Evidence and analysis are grounded in page content such as: the site's framing as a Classical Christian school and references to the Grammar stage and the Trivium, daily worship/music, Scripture memory, and formation-focused language. Notable examples include: "Destiny Christian School and Preschool is a Classical Christian school," "we base our teaching and learning on proven methods of education that have stood the test of time. The Grammar stage," and "Classical Education ... Grammar, Logic

and Rhetoric,” as well as explicit liturgical and faith-language throughout public pages. See citations to Destiny sources and the Six Essentials lexicon below.

- Positive keyword indicators from the classical school lexicon (and Six Essential Elements) align with Destiny’s language about truth, virtue, worship, theology, liturgy, wonder, and formation, supporting the CLASSICAL assessment. See the Positive Keyword sections and sample terms in the lexicon and Six Elements documents.
- For completeness, a snapshot of representative Destiny passages:
 - “Starting each day with singing is what we do at Destiny.”
 - “Destiny Christian School and Preschool is a Classical Christian school.”
 - “God is the Creator of all. All knowledge begins and ends with Him. Biblical standards and prayer are the foundation of our culture.”
 - “The Trivium (Three Roads) ... Grammar, Logic and Rhetoric.”
 - “Grammar stage ... memorizing things ... sense of wonder and a love of repetition.”

Note: All six categories reached CLASSICAL, based on explicit programmatic signals (Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric; worship and liturgical practices; formation-focused purpose; classical pedagogy signals; teacher models; and parent/community partnership).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Destiny frames its program as Classical Christian, with explicit references to God as Creator and to a biblical worldview as foundational to all learning. Public pages describe biblical standards and prayer as foundational to school culture, and Scripture is integrated into daily routines (e.g., Bible verses set to music; worship songs at start of day). - A YouTube/overview piece and public copy describe a liturgical rhythm (worship, singing) that shapes daily life in classrooms (e.g., “Starting each day with singing is what we do at Destiny”). - The site emphasizes a community of faith with teachers who are Christians and a curriculum rooted in a biblical worldview.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: God, Creator, biblical worldview, worship, liturgy, prayer, sacred, faith, reverence, wonder. The classical lexicon lists “theology,” “liturgy,” “wonder,” “worship,” and “truth, goodness, beauty” as positive signals; Destiny’s materials consistently use these themes. - Negative keywords: None evident in Destiny’s public materials (no explicit secular or relativistic signals found in the public-facing content). The lexicon’s negative indicators (e.g., relativism, secular humanism) are not present in the Destiny materials.

Why this rating - Destiny’s public-facing content anchors education in a theological anthropology and liturgical life, aligning with transcendental realism and a shared sense of the sacred. The explicit integration of theology with curriculum and communal worship signals a strong religious/metaphysical foundation typical of CLASSICAL schools.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school presents education as formation of virtue and wisdom (not solely job preparation). Public claims include “a proven model of education that builds character and trains every student how to think and how to learn,” and “Excellence in Faith & Academics,” which signals formation over information. - Recurrent emphasis on Grammar-Stage pedagogy and long-standing history (“35+ year legacy”) indicate telos-oriented aims beyond mere information transfer.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, teleology, truth/beauty, great conversation, moral imagination, classical mission, human flourishing. These terms appear in Destiny’s framing of its mission and in the knowledge-base lexicon’s categories. - Negative keywords: None evident (Destiny does not foreground workforce-readiness or narrow job-prep language in

its stated mission). The absence of “workforce readiness” framing aligns with a CLASSICAL emphasis on formation.

Why this rating - Destiny’s stated mission centers formation (character, virtue, wisdom) and a classical telos, aligning with CLASSICAL criteria for purposes/goals.

Element 3: Curriculum — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The public materials articulate the Trivium: Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric, and describe the Grammar stage as foundational (including memorization and chant). The Trivium framework is presented as the pathway through elementary to high school, shaping content across disciplines. - Specific curricular elements referenced include Saxon Math, Shurley English grammar, Latin, and BJU Press Science, which align with classical curricula and memory-based/recitation approaches typical of the Grammar stage. - The site emphasizes that Classical Christian Education is a growth-path (Grammar→Logic→Rhetoric) and that education should incorporate memorization, recitation, and rhythm (e.g., songs for grammar and memory).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books (implicit in classical canon framing), Latin, memorization/recitation, chants, sacred art, Western/Christian tradition. The lexicon lists grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; memorization; and Latin among positives; Destiny’s content aligns with many of these signals. - Negative keywords: Some lexical signals warn against a purely project-based or STEM-first framing; Destiny’s materials emphasize classical content rather than projects-first pedagogy. There is no clear project-first emphasis in Destiny’s public materials, which supports a CLASSICAL orientation.

Why this rating - Destiny’s curriculum signals strongly reflect the classical triad (Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric) and associated memory/recitation modes, plus traditional subjects associated with classical education (Latin, classical math/grammar curricula). This aligns with CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Lower-division pedagogy emphasizes singing, chanting, and memory-work; “grammar-stage memory/chanting” is repeatedly described in Destiny’s materials as a core method (e.g., memory verses, songs to learn grammar, etc.). - The Trivium narrative explains progression from Grammar to Logic to Rhetoric, with explicit emphasis on memorization and recitation as foundational pedagogy (e.g., “We memorize and data gather” in Grammar stage; “We begin to apply Logic” and “Rhetoric” as students advance). - Public content also emphasizes contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) as part of the approach, alongside active pursuit of rhetoric and public speaking skills as students advance. While the site foregrounds liturgy and memory work, it also signals opportunities for dialogue and rhetoric through the Trivium framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic/dialogic discourse (conceptual via the Trivium framework and “great conversation” language in the lexicon), Scholé/restful learning, recitation, chanting, memory work, rhetoric, dialogue-based instruction, and study in a traditional, contemplative cadence. The lexicon provides explicit signals for these pedagogical modes; Destiny demonstrates several of them (memory work, singing, recitation, grammar-stage pedagogy). - Negative keywords: The public materials do not emphasize exclusively project-based or constructivist/experiential-only pedagogy; rather, classical modes are foregrounded. The lack of a dominant non-classical pedagogy in Destiny’s materials supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Destiny’s pedagogy aligns with the classical pedagogy matrix: memory/schanting/repetition for the grammar stage, transition to logic and rhetoric, and a blend of contemplative/restful learning with active rhetoric and public speaking in the upper grades. This supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: Faculty — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Destiny emphasizes that teachers model virtue and are part of the living curriculum; there are references to teachers investing in the school and to a Christian faculty that forms part of the school’s culture

(e.g., “The teachers invest by forgoing higher pay,” and “teachers are exclusively Christians”). This signals a faculty as moral exemplars and core to the school’s ethos.

- The public materials describe a culture of partnership with families and a historical, mission-driven school community; the principal and staff are highlighted in public content, reinforcing a faculty-centered, virtue-guiding model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, model teachers, mentors, guardians of virtue, collegial culture, moral exemplars, master-teacher model. The classical lexicon identifies similar indicators (living curriculum, portrait of teacher, master-teacher model; ethical formation). Destiny’s public materials align with these signals. - Negative keywords: None evident in Destiny’s public materials (no signals of remedial or non-classical faculty models in the public content). The Lexicon negative terms (e.g., “facilitators,” “non-traditional instruction”) do not appear as governing descriptions of Destiny’s faculty.

Why this rating - Destiny presents its teachers as central to formation and as embodiments of the school’s values, consistent with CLASSICAL criteria for faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Destiny emphasizes partnership with families as co-educators and invites parental involvement (open campus, parent formation, book groups, seminars). The school explicitly describes parent engagement as part of its classical ethos. - The site highlights open tours, open houses, and parent-oriented communications (e.g., “Schedule A Tour,” “Open House Registration,” and “Your Child Deserves Excellence In Faith And Learning” messaging). This signals a strong parent-community integration. - The community signals include a network of 39 area churches contributing to the student body and a culture of faith-life integration, which aligns with classical “partnership with families” and cultural transmission aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, home-school alignment, family catechesis, parental engagement, open campus, welcoming visits. The Six Essential Elements lexicon treats these as essential signals; Destiny’s site is rich with these themes. - Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no consumerization or minimal parent involvement signals). The lexicon’s negative signals (e.g., “parent as customer only”) do not appear in Destiny’s content.

Why this rating - Destiny demonstrates a strong partner model with families and a community orientation, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for parents and community engagement.

Aggregate Assessment - All six categories are CLASSICAL. Taken together, Destiny Christian School Preschool Ny 14620 meets the Classical rubric across religious foundations, purpose/goal, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement. The evidence indicates a robust CLASSICAL orientation reinforced by a Christian worldview and a Trivium-anchored approach.

What would move the needle - Not applicable here since all six categories are CLASSICAL. No category requires needle-moving changes to achieve a CLASSICAL rating across the board.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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